



Appeal Decision

Site visit made on 11 August 2026

by R Sabu BA(Hons), MA, BArch, PgDip, RIBA, ARB

an Inspector appointed by the Secretary of State

Decision date: 11th September 2026

Appeal Ref: 6006506

Waldens Manor, Waldens Road, Orpington BR5 4EU

- The appeal is made under section 20 of the Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act 1990 (as amended) against a refusal to grant listed building consent.
 - The appeal is made by Richard Plasek against the decision of the Council of the London Borough of Bromley.
 - The application Ref is 24/01895/LBC.
 - The works proposed are demolition of existing conservatory extension and existing bay window. Construction of single storey rear extension with light lantern. Single storey rear extension to existing basement to create habitable space.
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Decision

1. The appeal is dismissed and listed building consent is refused for demolition of existing conservatory extension and existing bay window. Construction of single storey rear extension with light lantern. Single storey rear extension to existing basement to create habitable space.

Preliminary Matters

2. A new version of the National Planning Practice Framework (Framework) was published in August 2026. I have consulted the main parties and taken any comments into account in reaching my decision.
3. As the appeal relates to a listed building consent, I have had special regard to section 16(2) of the Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act 1990 (the Act).
4. Although the application form and decision notice refer to Waldens Manor, as the list description names the building as Walden Manor, I have used Walden Manor in the main issue below.

Main Issue

5. The main issue is whether the proposal would preserve a Grade II listed building, Walden Manor, and any of the features of special architectural or historic interest that it possesses.

Reasons

6. The building was first listed in 1954 and dates from the 17th century. As stated in the Heritage Statement, the building is a good example of a likely early 17th century vernacular building which was re-fronted and extended during the late 17th or early 18th century, with extensive surviving fabric and plan form from both phases of development.

7. The building comprises two distinctive phases of development: a north frontage was added during the late 17th or early 18th century to a retained interior and rear wing retained from an early 17th century timber-framed building.
8. In the 17th century the house passed through a number of owners including Caleb Trenchfield who was the son of one of the admirals of the navy under Charles I. In the 19th century, Walden Manor formed part of the Lullingstone Estate in the ownership of Sir Percival Hart Dyke of Lullingstone Castle, by which time it was likely part of a farmstead.
9. Given the above, I find that the special interest of the listed building, insofar as it relates to these appeals, to be primarily associated with legibility of the phases of the building and evidence of historic fabric and plan form.
10. The proposal includes the demolition of the existing conservatory extension and bay window. Both features date from the late 19th and 20th century, however, given their modest scale do not detract from the significance of the building. As the conservatory and bay window do not provide a positive contribution to the significance of the building, their removal would not harm the special interest of the heritage asset.
11. The proposed rear extension would extend across most of the width of the two storey rear element of the building that dates from the 17th century. It would be single storey with a flat roof, and the height would be almost at the bottom of the first floor windows. I note the continuous parapet, brickwork detailing and open loggia. However, together with the lantern roof light, the height, width and massing of the extension would unacceptably obscure views of large parts of the historic rear elevation. Therefore, the scheme would diminish the legibility of the 17th century elevation, thereby eroding the special interest of the listed building.
12. The proposed extension would include details from the host building such as raised band of brickwork and would echo the materials such as brickwork. However, it would include full height doors with extensive glazing that would appear incongruous against the 17th century rear elevation. While the use of glazing may take the form of an orangery extension and the scheme would be clearly discernible from the host building, given the scale and form of the extension, it would nonetheless egregiously detract from the legibility and character of the rear elevation.
13. Precise details and materials could be controlled via a suitably worded condition. However, given the harm to the legibility of the rear elevation that would result from the scale and form of the proposal, such conditions would not make the proposal acceptable.
14. The Council do not appear to have concerns regarding the proposed basement. Given its location, I find that the proposed basement would preserve the special interest of the listed building.
15. Consequently, the proposal would fail to preserve a Grade II listed building, Walden Manor, and any of the features of special architectural or historic interest that it possesses.
16. In the terms of the Framework, the proposal would result in harm to the significance of a heritage asset, from work affecting the asset itself. The harm

would be substantial as the proposal would seriously affect a key element of the asset's significance. In this case, the proposal would unacceptably erode the legibility and character of the 17th century rear elevation.

17. Paragraph 1 of Policy HE6 of the Framework states that when considering the potential effect of a development proposal on the significance of a designated heritage asset, substantial weight should be given to the asset's conservation (and the more important the asset, the greater the weight should be). This is irrespective of whether any potential effect amounts to a positive effect, harm, substantial harm, or total loss of its significance.
18. The policy goes on to say that where a development proposal would harm the significance of a designated heritage asset the effect on the asset and its significance should be weighed against any public benefits resulting from the proposal. Important public benefits can include securing the long-term reuse of a vacant or underused listed building and enabling energy efficiency and low carbon heating measures to be employed.
19. Public benefits such as enabling energy efficiency are not before me. Even if the proposal did result in any such benefit, they would not outweigh the harm identified, given the scale of the proposal. In any event, the continued viable use of the appeal property as a residential dwelling is not dependent on the proposal as the building has an ongoing residential use that would not cease in its absence.
20. As the proposal would unacceptably alter the legibility of the rear elevation, the harm to the designated heritage asset would be substantial. The Framework states that in this circumstance, consent should be refused unless it can be demonstrated that the harm is necessary to achieve substantial public benefits that outweigh the harm or loss, or if a number of factors apply. The listed factors are not applicable in this case, and the scheme would not give rise to substantial public benefits.
21. Given the above I find that the proposal would fail to preserve the special interest of the listed building. Therefore, it would conflict with Policy HC1 of The London Plan The Spatial Development Strategy for Greater London March 2021 and Policy 38 of the Bromley Local Plan (January 2019) which together require development proposals affecting heritage assets to conserve their significance and special interest by being sympathetic to the assets' significance.

Conclusion

22. For the reasons given above, I conclude that the appeal should be dismissed.

R Sabu

INSPECTOR